

HUBBU

SHOULD WE AUTOMATE THIS?

A One-Page Decision Framework for Real Estate Businesses

Use this when a task feels repetitive, slow, error-prone, or expensive. The goal is to decide in 10 minutes whether to automate now, pilot, or fix the process first.

AI will follow rules if you provide them. It just won't invent them for you.

Connect: [linkedin.com/in/taofeek-ai](https://www.linkedin.com/in/taofeek-ai) | Read more: theaibroker.substack.com

1. Define the Task

Field	Answer
Task name	Example: "Follow up with new web leads"
Who does it today?	Agent, ISA, admin, team lead, broker
Where does it happen?	CRM, email, SMS, phone, calendar, transaction file
How often?	Daily, weekly, per lead, per listing, per deal
What is the pain?	Missed leads, slow response, forgotten follow-up, rework
What would improve?	Speed, appointments, closings, reviews, time saved

2. Red-Flag Check

If any of these are true, do not fully automate yet. Use human review, fix the process, or keep it manual.

Red Flag	If Yes
Does it require licensed judgment? Example: contract advice, negotiation strategy, appraisal, legal interpretation	Keep human-led
Is the process different every time?	Document it first
Is it emotionally sensitive? Example: complaint, bereavement, foreclosure crisis, angry seller	Human-first, automation supports only
Does it involve fair housing, compliance, or contractual risk without review?	Add human approval
Is the data scattered across inboxes, spreadsheets, sticky notes, and people's heads?	Clean and centralize first

3. Score the Task

Score each item from 1 to 5.

Criterion	Question	Scoring Guide
Volume	How often does this happen?	1 = under 10/month, 3 = 10-100/month, 5 = 100+/month
Time pain	How much time is lost?	1 = under 1 hr/month, 3 = 1-5 hrs/month, 5 = 10+ hrs/month
Revenue impact	Does it affect leads, appointments, deals, reviews, or referrals?	1 = minor, 5 = directly affects revenue
Repeatability	Is it rule-based and predictable?	1 = unique every time, 5 = clear if/then steps
Data readiness	Is the needed info already in CRM, forms, or calendar?	1 = scattered, 5 = structured and available
Error reduction	Do manual mistakes cause missed deals or rework?	1 = low risk, 5 = high risk
Ease to pilot	Can we test it quickly with existing tools?	1 = over 1 month, 5 = under 1 week

4. Decision Rule

Add the score out of 35.

Score	Decision
28 - 35	Automate now
22 - 27	Run a 14-day pilot
Below 22	Do not automate yet; simplify or document first

If any red flag applies, downgrade the decision:

- "Automate now" becomes **human-assisted automation**
- "Pilot" becomes **manual process with automation support**
- "Do not automate" becomes **fix process first**

5. Automation Blueprint

If the answer is automate or pilot, define the minimum working version.

Component	Fill In
Trigger	What starts it? Example: new lead form submitted
Input	What data is needed? Name, phone, email, property interest
Action	What happens automatically? SMS, email, task creation, alert
Human checkpoint	Where does a person take over? Agent call, review, approval
Exception path	What if data is missing, contact opts out, or there is no response?
Output	What is the desired result? Appointment booked, document received, review requested
Success metric	What proves it worked? Response time, conversion rate, hours saved
Owner	Who is accountable? Team lead, ops manager, broker

6. Real Estate Examples to Test

Good automation candidates:

- New lead response
- Speed-to-lead follow-up
- Missed-call text-back
- Appointment reminders
- Showing confirmations
- Open house follow-up
- Review requests
- Listing milestone updates
- Document chase reminders
- Buyer consultation booking
- Seller weekly report reminders
- Vendor and maintenance request intake
- Expired listing follow-up sequences
- Past client reactivation campaigns
- Referral request after closing

Usually not good for full automation:

- Contract negotiation
- Legal advice

- Pricing strategy
- Appraisal opinions
- Complaint handling
- Emotional crisis conversations
- Fair housing-sensitive decisions

7. Example in Action

Task: New Rents Onboarding Workflow

Field	Answer
Task	Onboard every new rental unit and tenant into the property management system
Current problem	Lease data is entered manually from paperwork, onboarding is slow, and errors delay the first rent charge
Desired outcome	Faster onboarding, fewer data entry errors, rent schedule active from day one

Score

Criterion	Score
Volume	5
Time pain	4
Revenue impact	5
Repeatability	5
Data readiness	4
Error reduction	4
Ease to pilot	5
Total	32 / 35

Decision

Automate now.

Blueprint

Component	Example
Trigger	New lease signed and marked ready in the property management system
Input	Tenant name, unit, rent amount, lease start date, deposit, payment method
Action	Auto-create rent ledger, generate payment schedule, and send tenant welcome email
Human checkpoint	Property manager reviews lease terms before the account is activated
Exception path	If lease data is incomplete, flag for manual entry; if payment method is missing, hold activation
Output	Tenant onboarded with an active rent schedule in the system
Success metric	Onboarding time under 10 minutes, zero data entry errors, first rent charge on time
Owner	Property manager or operations lead

8. Run It Today

1. Pick one painful real estate task.
 2. Fill in the task definition.
 3. Check the red flags.
 4. Score it out of 35.
 5. Apply the decision rule.
 6. If it passes, complete the automation blueprint.
 7. Launch a 14-day pilot on one team, one office, or one lead source.
 8. Measure before and after.
 9. Scale only if it saves time, reduces errors, or improves response and conversion.
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Built by HUBBU

Building augmentation systems for real estate teams

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